TidyTuesday Week 46

Pranay Gundam

Tuesday 10th November, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly segment where we bravely shove two unrelated economic time series into a blender and solemnly report on the smoothie. This week was a quiet one – only two days of data – but what the schedule lacked in volume it made up for in the time-honored tradition of statistics promising me the world and then quietly walking it back.

Monday the 9th opened strong, and by "strong" I mean borderline suspicious. We paired the Rest of the World's debt securities and loans liabilities – a global, decades-long pile of money – against, and I cannot stress how randomly, per capita spending on housing and utilities in the Plains BEA region. The raw regression came back with an R-squared of 0.96. Ninety-six percent! A p-value with more zeros after the decimal than I have fingers! For one glorious moment I was ready to write the paper, book the Nobel flight, and explain to the world how the planet's debt load secretly governs the heating bills of Nebraska. Then I ran the detrended version and the R-squared faceplanted to 0.15. Turns out both series mostly just go up over time, which is the economic equivalent of two strangers both aging and then being accused of a conspiracy. There was a faint flicker of something left over (barely squeaking past significance), but let's be honest: this was a textbook trend mirage, and this project exists specifically to point and laugh at trend mirages.

Tuesday the 10th had no such drama, bless it. We matched a gloriously specific discontinued series about the percent of mid-size loans made under syndication at large domestic banks against the import price index for household appliances. The raw regression's R-squared was a majestic 0.005, which is to say the two series regarded each other with total indifference, and the p-value of 0.76 confirmed they'd never met. Detrending nudged things to a blistering 0.01 R-squared, somehow making an already nonexistent relationship slightly less existent. Refreshing, honestly. Nothing clears the palate after a 0.96 heartbreak like two series that are proudly, defiantly uncorrelated.

As always, the mandatory disclaimer that is also the entire point: these are randomly paired series yanked from FRED with zero theory, zero hypothesis, and zero causal claim. When something lines up here, spurious is the default assumption, not the exception – the fun is watching which flashy correlations survive the detrending gauntlet and which ones (looking at you, global debt and Plains utility bills) crumple the instant you take away their shared staircase. This week: one dramatic collapse, one dignified mutual snub. See you next week for more rigorous nonsense.

2 Date: 2026-11-09

Series ID: DODFFSWCMI
This series is titled Rest of the World; Debt Securities and Loans; Liability, Level and has a frequency of Quarterly, End of Period. The units are Millions of U.S. Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted Annual Rate.The observation start date is 1945-10-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01.The popularity of this series is 15.

Series ID: PLNSPCEPCHOUSUTL
This series is titled Per Capita Personal Consumption Expenditures: Services: Housing and Utilities for Plains BEA Region and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1997-01-01 and the observation end date is 2025-01-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PLNSPCEPCHOUSUTL	**R-squared:**	0.961
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.959
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	660.0
Date:	Mon, 09 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	1.64e-20
Time:	21:41:25	**Log-Likelihood:**	-207.55
No. Observations:	29	**AIC:**	419.1
Df Residuals:	27	**BIC:**	421.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	3193.5604	115.903	27.554	0.000	2955.747	3431.374
value_fred_DODFFSWCMI	0.0008	3.03e-05	25.690	0.000	0.001	0.001

Omnibus:	0.836	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.483
Prob(Omnibus):	0.658	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	0.750
Skew:	0.053	**Prob(JB):**	0.687
Kurtosis:	2.219	**Cond. No.**	7.43e+06

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

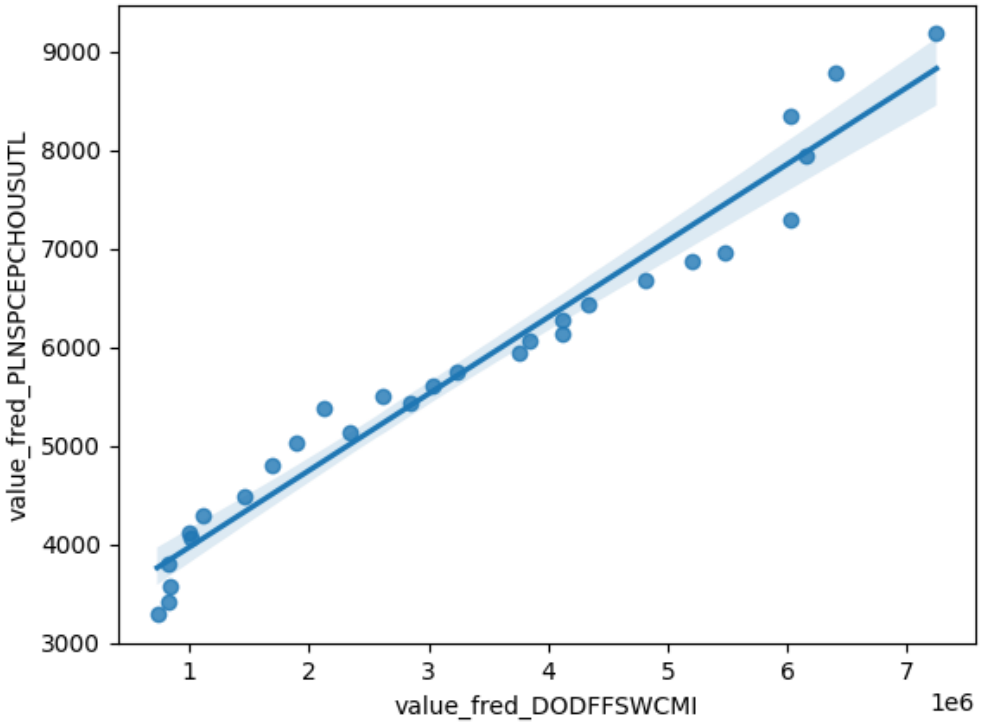


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-11-09

[2] The condition number is large, 7.43e+06. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PLNSPCEPCHOUSUTL_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.152
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	0.121
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	4.857
Date:	Mon, 09 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.0363
Time:	21:41:25	**Log-Likelihood:**	-204.23
No. Observations:	29	**AIC:**	412.5
Df Residuals:	27	**BIC:**	415.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-2.367e-12	53.276	-4.44e-14	1.000	-109.314	109.314
value_fred_DODFFSWCMI_detrended	0.0004	0.000	2.204	0.036	2.46e-05	0.001

Omnibus:	1.083	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.261
Prob(Omnibus):	0.582	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	0.897
Skew:	0.409	**Prob(JB):**	0.638
Kurtosis:	2.726	**Cond. No.**	3.29e+05

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 3.29e+05. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

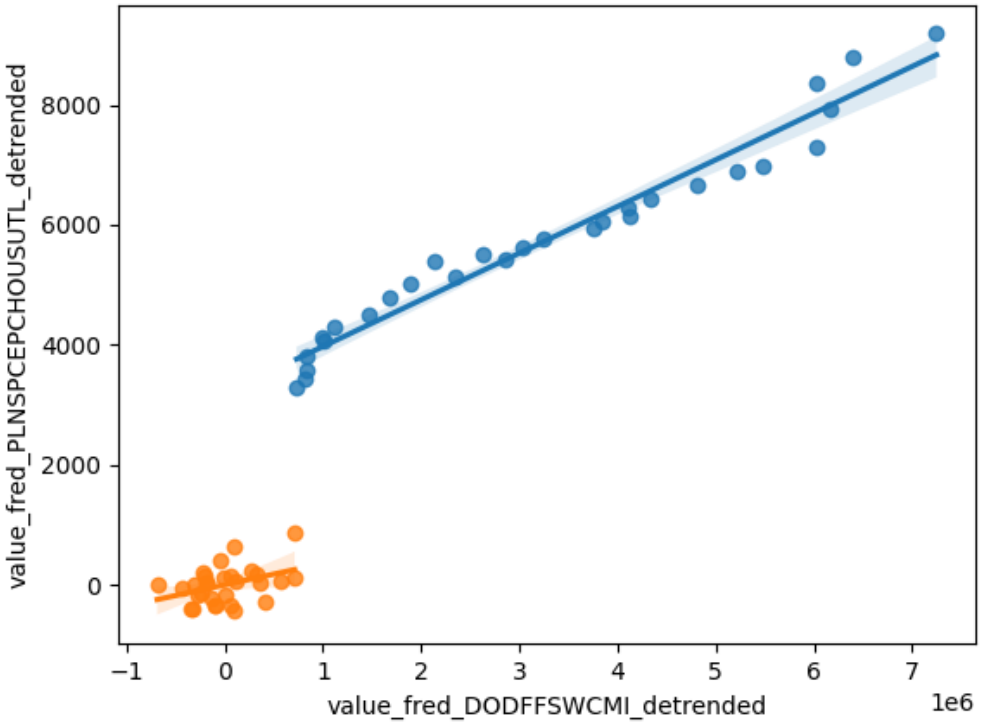


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-11-09

3 Date: 2026-11-10

Series ID: EF1T99XSLNQ
This series is titled Percent of Value of Loans Made Under Participation or Syndication by Size of Loan: ($ Thousands) $10 to $99, Large Domestic Banks (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, 2nd Month's 1st Full Week. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2012-07-01 and the observation end date is 2017-04-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: IR41030
This series is titled Import Price Index (End Use): Household Appliances and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index 2000=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1984-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-09-01.The popularity of this series is 3.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IR41030	**R-squared:**	0.005
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.050
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.09834
Date:	Tue, 10 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.757
Time:	18:58:16	**Log-Likelihood:**	-48.115
No. Observations:	20	**AIC:**	100.2
Df Residuals:	18	**BIC:**	102.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	110.6895	1.199	92.314	0.000	108.170	113.209
value_fred_EF1T99XSLNQ	-0.0286	0.091	-0.314	0.757	-0.221	0.163

Omnibus:	1.232	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.197
Prob(Omnibus):	0.540	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	1.035
Skew:	-0.357	**Prob(JB):**	0.596
Kurtosis:	2.145	**Cond. No.**	25.0

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

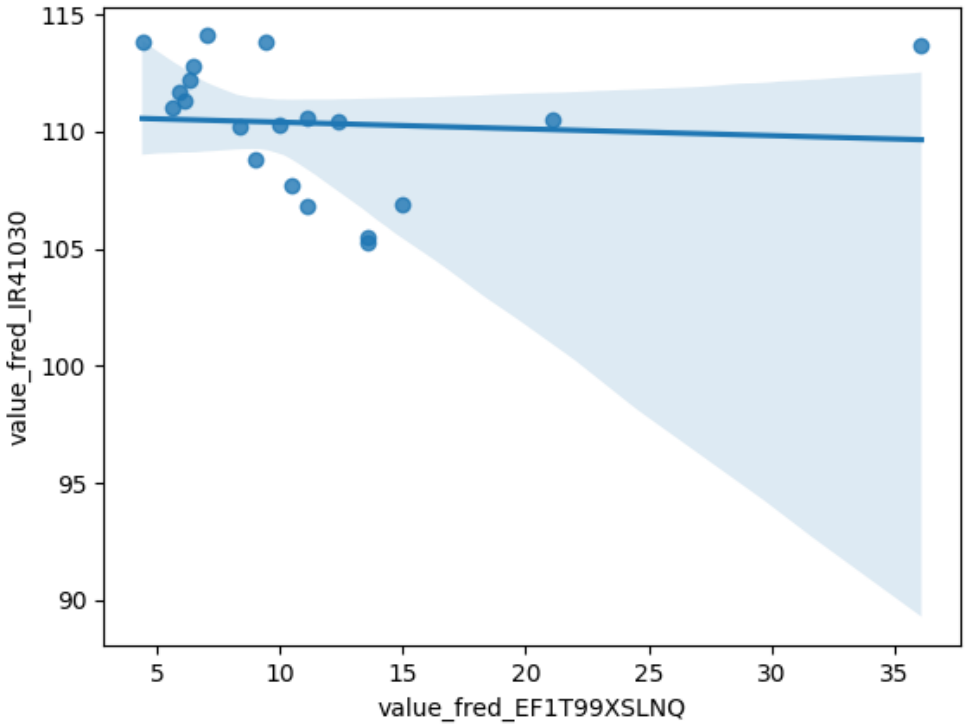


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-11-10

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IR41030_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.011
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.044
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.1915
Date:	Tue, 10 Nov 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.667
Time:	18:58:16	**Log-Likelihood:**	-31.490
No. Observations:	20	**AIC:**	66.98
Df Residuals:	18	**BIC:**	68.97
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	1.939e-12	0.275	7.04e-12	1.000	-0.579	0.579
value_fred_EF1T99XSLNQ_detrended	0.0176	0.040	0.438	0.667	-0.067	0.102

Omnibus:	0.487	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.960
Prob(Omnibus):	0.784	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	0.071
Skew:	0.145	**Prob(JB):**	0.965
Kurtosis:	3.008	**Cond. No.**	6.86

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

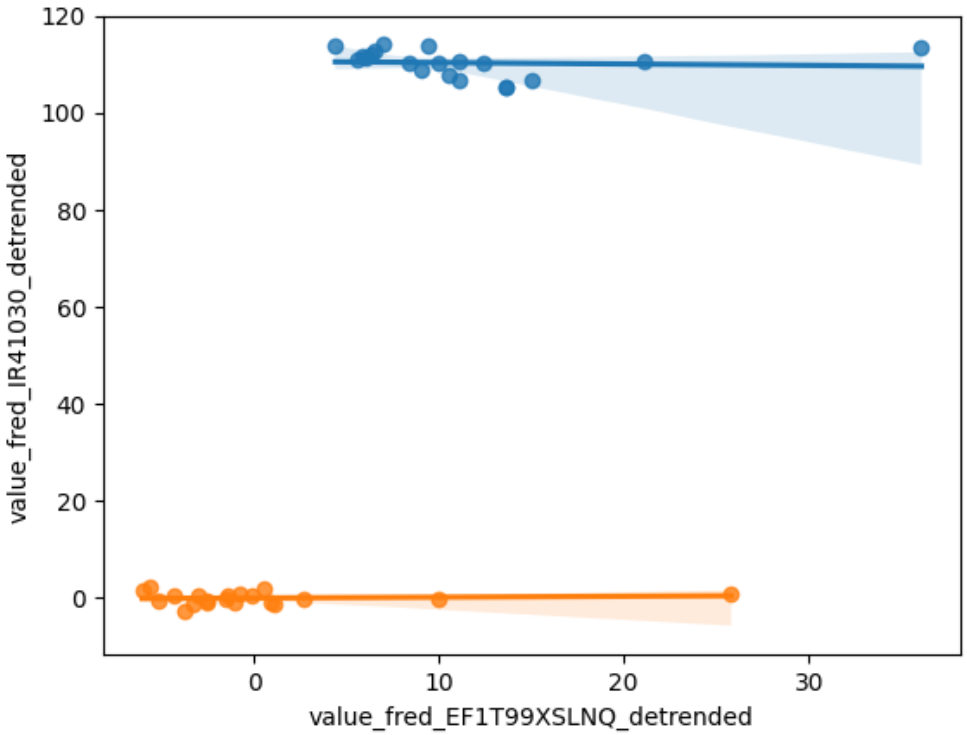


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-11-10